EXP 8

Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator Application Gym Membership Enrollment

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1. AIM

To configure user management and role-based access control (RBAC) for the "Gym Membership Enrollment" application in Zoho Creator, so that every category of staff — Admin, Gym Manager, Receptionist, Trainer, and portal-based members — is assigned an appropriately scoped role and permission profile, record visibility follows the reporting hierarchy, and the application interface is localized correctly for each user, without granting any user access beyond what their role requires.

2. PROCEDURE

2.1 Defining Roles and the Role Hierarchy

1. Open the application in Zoho Creator and go to Settings > Permissions > User Permissions > Roles tab. Select the "Manager" role, set "Reports to" as CEO, and add a description such as "Manages and reviews gym membership enrollment records".
2. Enable "Share Data with Peers" so that users placed under the same role can view each other's records, and under the Role Hierarchy table enable role hierarchy for the "Membership_Enrollment_Form" module with Record Owner set to "Added User".

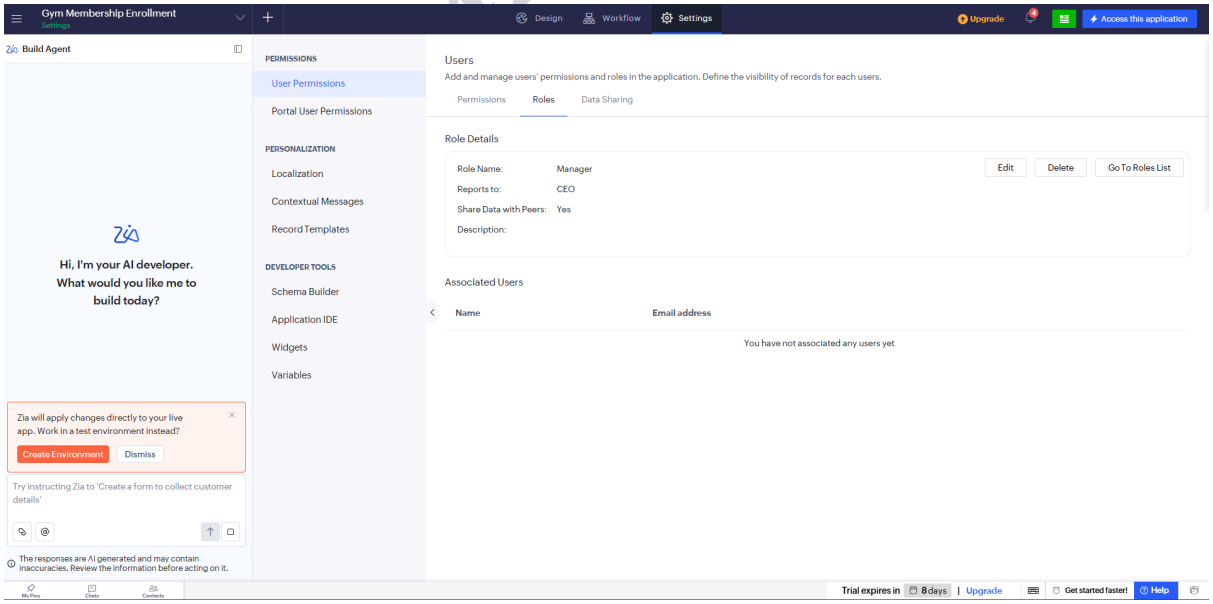


Fig 2.1: Roles tab — Manager role configured with reporting hierarchy

Explanation: The "Reports to" field builds the reporting chain (Manager → CEO) that Zoho Creator uses to decide which records a role can see above its own. Enabling role hierarchy on "Membership_Enrollment_Form" means a Manager automatically inherits visibility over enrollment records owned by the staff reporting to them, while "Share Data with Peers" extends that visibility

sideways to others holding the same role — together this defines the vertical and horizontal reach of the Manager role's access.

2.2 Creating Permission Profiles for Each Staff Category

3. Go to Settings > Permissions > User Permissions > Permissions tab and click "Add Permission" to create a separate permission profile for every staff category that uses the application — Admin, Gym Manager, Member, Receptionist, and Trainer — each with its own descriptive profile name, alongside the built-in Read and Write profiles.

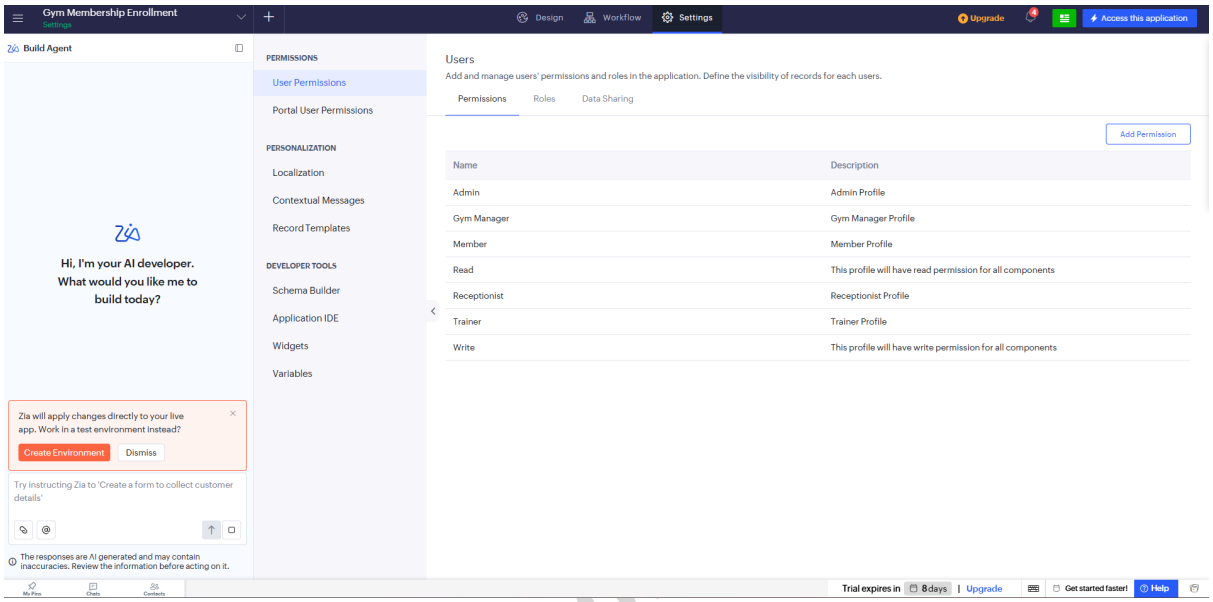


Fig 2.2: Permissions tab listing the individual permission profiles created for each role

Explanation: Each permission profile is an independently editable set of module-level and field-level access rights. Splitting users into named profiles such as Admin, Gym Manager, Receptionist, and Trainer — rather than using one shared profile — ensures each role sees and can act on only the forms and reports relevant to its function, which is the core of role-based access control.

2.3 Setting Portal User Permissions

4. Go to the "Portal User Permissions" tab to manage access for portal users — members or staff who interact with the application from outside the core organisation. Here the "Customer", "Manager_permission", and "Trainer_permission" profiles are exposed as portal-level permissions.

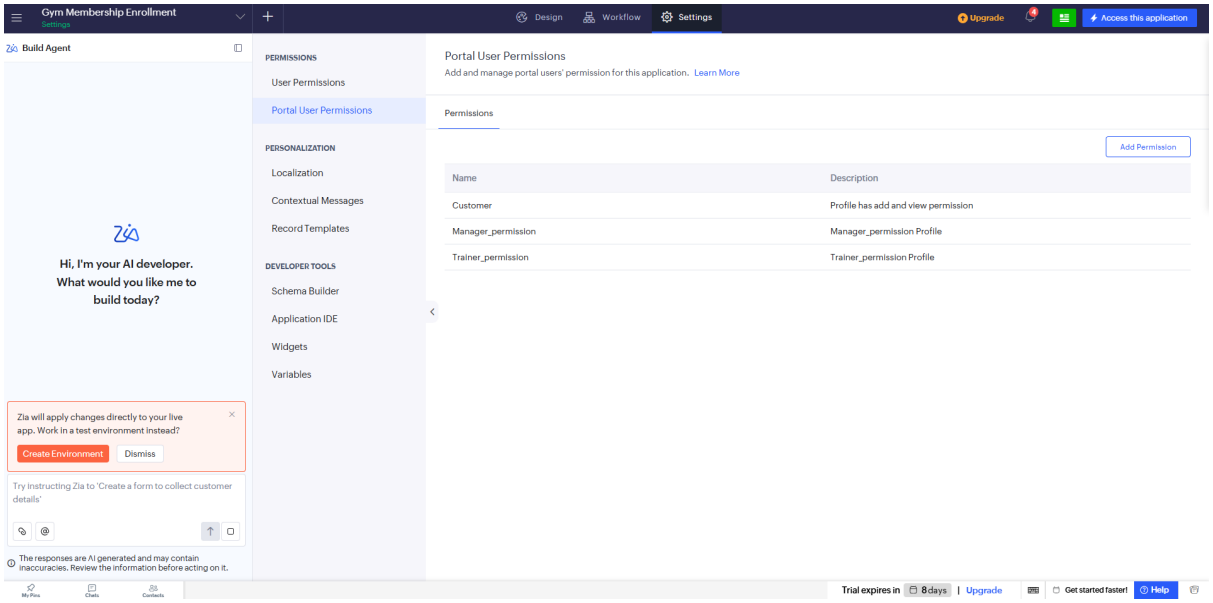


Fig 2.3: Portal User Permissions tab showing the profiles available to portal users

Explanation: Portal users are kept separate from internal application users so that member- or trainer-facing accounts can be granted a restricted subset of permissions — here limited to the Customer, Manager_permission, and Trainer_permission profiles — without exposing the full set of internal roles or developer-facing settings.

2.4 Configuring Application Localization

5. Go to Settings > Personalization > Localization and choose which language the application should use. "User's browser language" is selected, alongside the option to fall back to English as the default language.

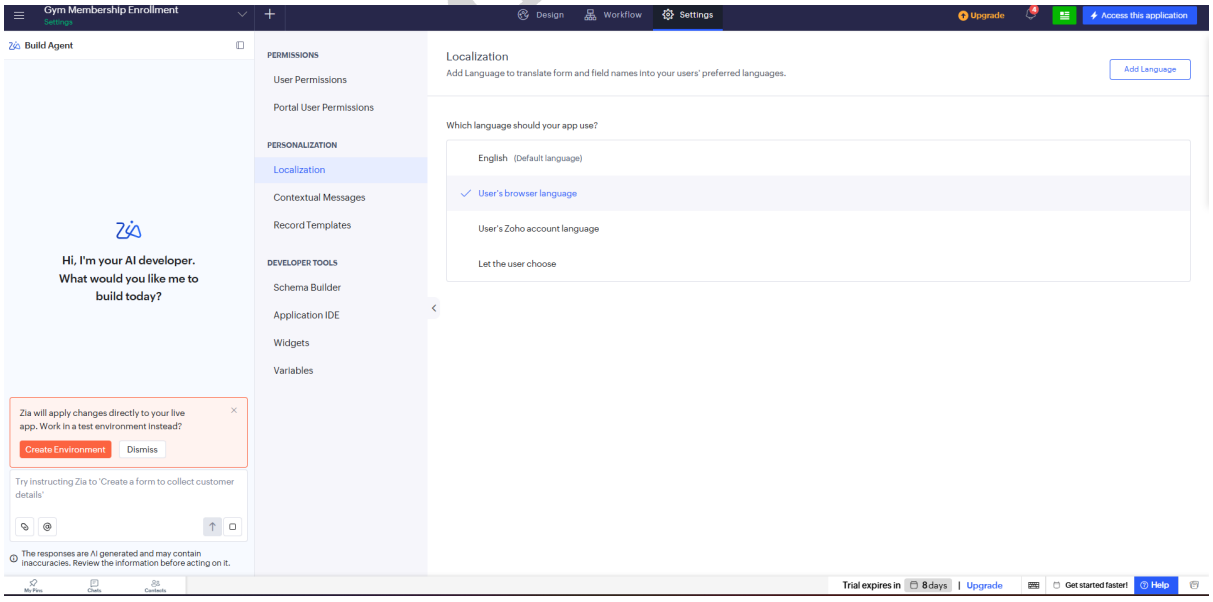


Fig 2.4: Localization settings for the application

Explanation: Localization works alongside RBAC to make the application usable for every role: once a user's permission profile determines what they can access, the localization setting determines the language in which that form or field content is displayed to them, based on their browser, their Zoho account language, or a language they choose themselves.

2.5 Verifying Workflow Automations Under the Configured Roles

6. Go to the Workflow tab > Form workflows to confirm that the automation built in Experiment 6 — the enrollment confirmation mail triggered on "Created > Successful form submission" — remains Enabled and continues to run correctly regardless of which permitted role triggers it.

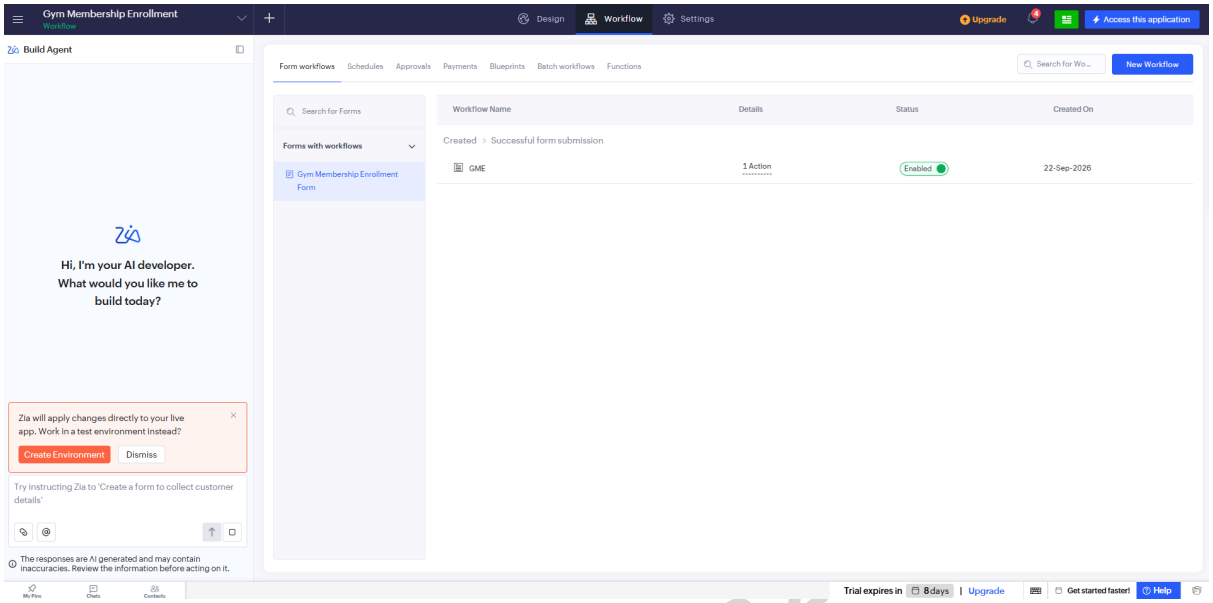


Fig 2.5: Form workflows list showing the enrollment confirmation automation still enabled

Explanation: The confirmation-mail workflow configured earlier fires on the Created record event regardless of which authorised role (Gym Manager, Receptionist, and so on) submits or edits the enrollment form. Because this automation sits beneath the permission and role layer, it continues to execute consistently no matter which role performs the action, confirming that RBAC and workflow automation operate together without conflict.

2.6 Adding a User and Assigning a Role and Permission

7. Open the Zoho Creator home page and go to Users > Add User. Enter the user's email address and name, keep "Send Notification Mail" ticked, and under Add to Application > Applications as User select the "Gym Membership Enrollment" application, set the Role to "Manager" and the Permission to "Gym Manager", then click Add User.

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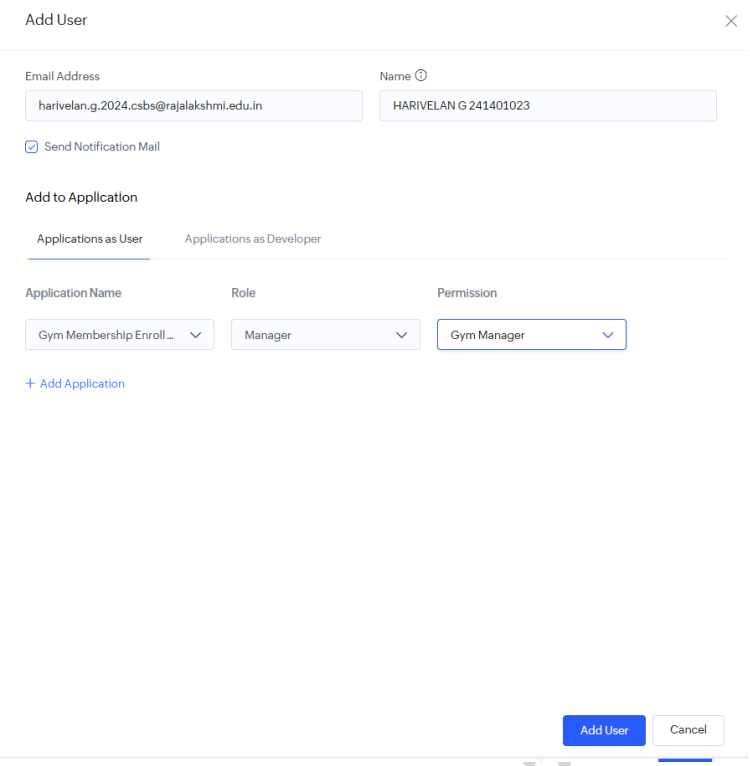


Fig 2.6: Add User dialog — user added to the application with the Manager role and Gym Manager permission

Explanation: Creating the user is what ties the role and permission profiles defined earlier to a real person. Selecting the Manager role places the user in the reporting hierarchy, and the Gym Manager permission decides which components the user can add or edit, so the user receives only the access that role requires. The notification mail invites the user to access the application.

3. OUTPUT

Once the roles, permission profiles, portal permissions and localization settings were saved and the user was added, the All Users page listed the users who now have access to the application.

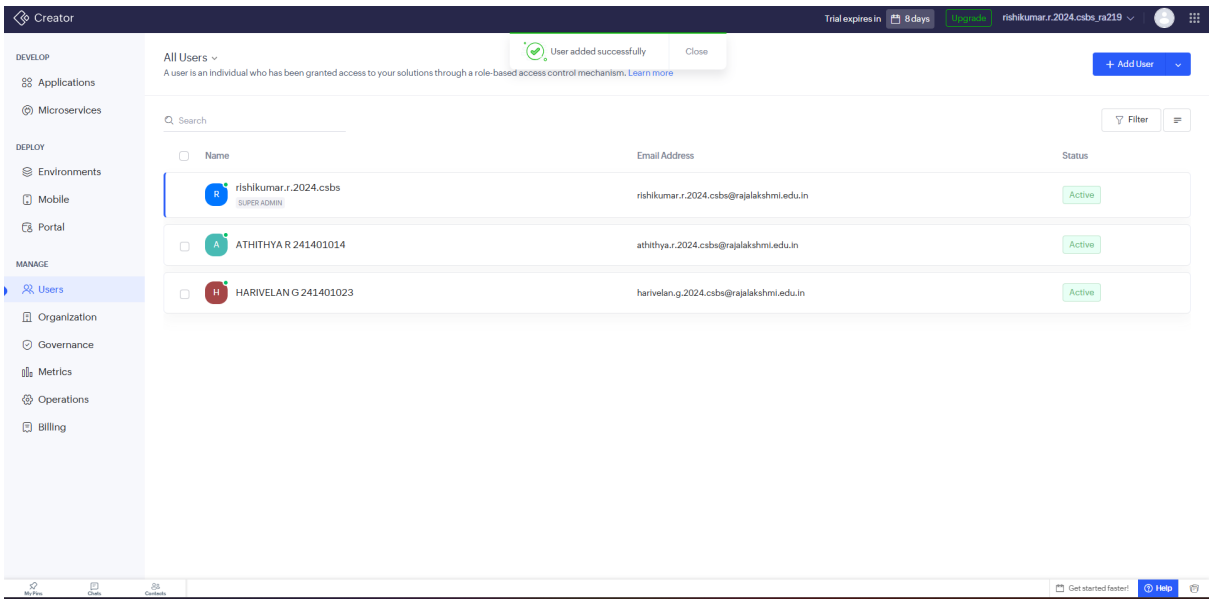


Fig 3: All Users page in Zoho Creator showing the users added to the application

Explanation: The All Users page confirms that the newly added user (HARIVELAN G) appears alongside the Super Admin account and an existing user (ATHITHYA R), and that every listed user has the status Active. This shows the role and permission assignment was saved successfully and that these users can now sign in and work in the application within the access granted to their role.

4. RESULT

Role-based access control was successfully configured for the "Gym Membership Enrollment" application in Zoho Creator. Distinct roles and permission profiles were created for each staff category, a reporting hierarchy was established for the Manager role with module-level record visibility, portal users were restricted to a limited set of permission profiles, and the application interface was localized to the user's browser language. This ensures every user interacts only with the data and features appropriate to their role, while workflow automations continue to run correctly underneath the configured access layer. A user was also added to the application with the Manager role and Gym Manager permission, and the user is listed as Active.

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